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PER CENT IN MUMBAI AND BANGALORE HAVE TRIED BLIND-FOLDED SEX. HOWEVER, 20 PER CENT OF WOMEN IN MUMBAI AND 5 PER CENT IN BANGALORE ARE GIVING IT SERIOUS THOUGHT.

toys was consistently higher than that for those who said that they had. Overall, a greater percentage of men had both tried sex toys as well as thought about trying them. Once again, in most cities, more men responded that they would like to try, than had tried. In as much as the significant taboo against sex toys might be yielding to a more relaxed attitude, it is interesting to note this trend among women. This, in turn, could be interpreted in different ways. First, it could suggest a crack in the edifice of male-centric (heterosexual) sexual culture, where the man is imagined as both the self-contained and exclusive agent of pleasure. Simultaneously, it may also point to the greater internalisation of consumer cultures, where the commodity is increasingly viewed as a route to pleasure, with sex toys signifying a straightforward adoption of this attitude.

What then of those items that are easier to acquire than sex toys? Chocolate sauce, ice, ice-cream and honey appear to be the most favoured items of sexual accompaniment. However, the women surveyed did not express overwhelming interest in these (with a range of 9 per cent to 11 per cent across the country) Perhaps, when libidinal economies are confronted by monetary ones, it is the latter that win out: given their cost, chocolate sauce and ice-cream may well grant greater satisfaction if consumed directly. In any case, how does one explain the mysteriously depleting stocks to the children? It is perhaps not surprising that Mumbai women with their higher disposable income had known chocolate sauce in ways other than as ice-cream topping. Overall, more men had both tried out and thought of trying out edible sticky substances as part of sexual routine (perhaps 'routine' is not the right word), with those in Delhi and Jaipur registering



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